

Strong 2-♣ Opening

Open 2♣ on any hand containing 22 or more points.

OR, open 2♣ with a hand containing 19-21 points and with 9+ playing tricks.

There are several methods of responding. For these Deals use the 2♦ Negative for all hands with 7 or fewer points. Any other response shows 8 or more points.

The 2♣ bid is artificial; Opener's second bid describes her hand.

2NT shows a balanced 22-24 point hand

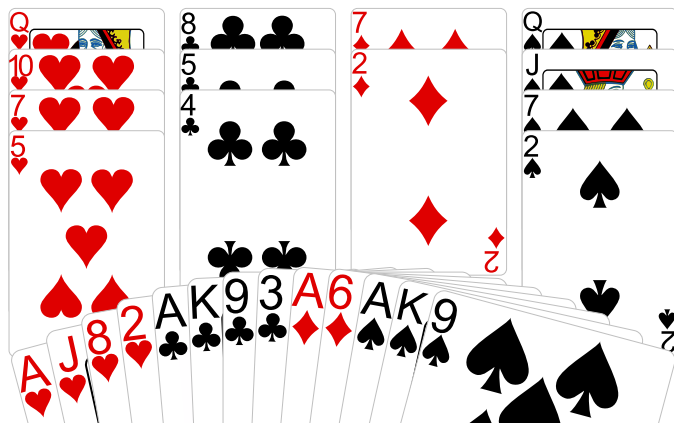
3NT shows a balanced 25-27 point hand

2 of a suit shows a 5-card or longer suit

With a very weak hand (0-3 points) Responder should bid the "second negative" at his second turn. This is usually 3♣, but if Opener bids 3♣ then it is 3♦. If Opener should bid 3♦ at his second turn the second negative bid is 3♥.

Later bidding depends on the partnership, but unless particular conventions are in use then later bidding is natural.

Deal 1 Ctr: 4♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



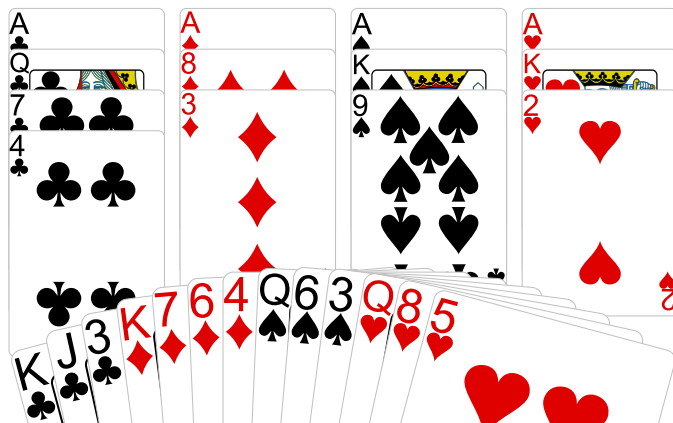
Count Fast and Slow Losers

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers

Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Deal 2 Ctr: 6NT Goal: at least ____ winners



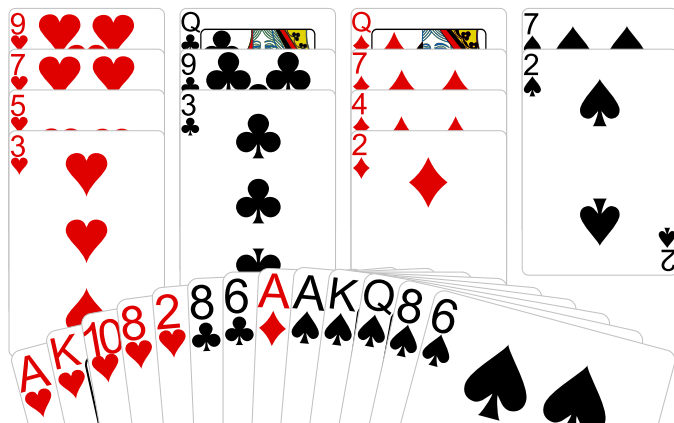
Count Sure Winners

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Develop Winners

Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Deal 3 Ctr: 4♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers

Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Deal 4 Ctr: 6NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Develop Winners

Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Board: 2

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: East

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: South

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: West

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: North

Deal 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ T 8 3
♥ 9 3
♦ K J 5 4 3
♣ Q 7 2

23
6 6
5

♠ A K 9
♥ A J 8 2
♦ A 6
♣ A K 9 3



♠ Q J 7 2
♥ Q T 7 5
♦ 7 2
♣ 8 5 4

♠ 6 5 4
♥ K 6 4
♦ Q T 9 8
♣ J T 6

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2NT	Pass	3♣
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			
4♥ by North			

suit and SOUTH bids 4

♥

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NORTH opens 2♣ and SOUTH responds 2

♦

showing fewer than 8 points.

NORTH bids 2NT with a 23 point balanced hand.

SOUTH has enough points to bid 3NT, but with two 4-card Major suits bids 3♣ Stayman instead. NORTH

won't confuse this as the second negative since that bid isn't used after a 2NT rebid.

So NORTH shows her 4-card

Deal 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A K 9
 ♥ A K 2
 ♦ A 8 3
 ♣ A Q 7 4

2
 24 11
 3

♠ 7 5 4
 ♥ J 9 7 6 4
 ♦ J T 9
 ♣ 9 2



♠ J T 8 2
 ♥ T 3
 ♦ Q 5 2
 ♣ T 8 6 5

♠ Q 6 3
 ♥ Q 8 5
 ♦ K 7 6 4
 ♣ K J 3

West	North	East	South
2♣	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT	Pass	6NT	
All Pass			
6NT by East			

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EAST has a balanced hand with 11 points, so she responds 2NT to WEST's 2♣ opening bid.

WEST bids 3NT. This shows 22-24 points, a hand he was planning to rebid 2NT.

EAST knows the side has at least 33 points, but no more than 35 so she bids 6NT.

Deal 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ T 9 5
♥ Q 4
♦ K J 9 8 5
♣ A 4 2

4
10 6
20

♠ 7 2
♥ 9 7 5 3
♦ Q 7 4 2
♣ Q 9 3



♠ A K Q 8 6
♥ A K T 8 2
♦ A
♣ 8 6

♠ J 4 3
♥ J 6
♦ T 6 3
♣ K J T 7 5

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			
4♥ by South			

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NORTH is happy to bid the game in



S.

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SOUTH has both Majors and enough points to open 2♣.

NORTH, with 4 points, responds with a negative 2



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SOUTH first bids her higher ranking suit, 2♠.

NORTH is too strong for second negative, he bids 2NT.

SOUTH now shows her second suit, 3



Deal 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q 2
 ♥ A K Q 5
 ♦ K 7 5
 ♣ K Q T

5
 23 11
 1

♠ 8 5 4
 ♥ J 7 3
 ♦ 9 2
 ♣ A 9 8 6 5

N
 W E
 S

♠ J T 9 6
 ♥ T 6 4
 ♦ T 4 3
 ♣ 7 4 3

♠ K 7 3
 ♥ 9 8 2
 ♦ A Q J 8 6
 ♣ J 2

West	North	East	South
2♣	Pass	3♦	Pass
3NT	Pass	6NT	
All Pass			
6NT by West			

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WEST has a balanced hand with 23 points. He opens 2♣ and expects to rebid 2NT.

EAST has 12 points so makes a positive response in her best suit. Since that suit is

♦

s she must jump to the 3-level.

WEST now describes his balanced, minimum hand by bidding 3NT.

EAST bids 6NT, knowing that the partnership holds at least 34 points.

Deal 5

North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 5 3
♥ 8 6 3
♦ 9 6 3
♣ 8 6 5 2

25
2 5
8

♠ K 6
♥ A K Q J 2
♦ K Q J
♣ K Q J



♠ A T 9 7 2
♥ 9 7 5
♦ 8 5 2
♣ A 3

♠ J 8 4
♥ T 4
♦ A T 7 4
♣ T 9 7 4

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♥
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

6♥ by North

NORTH thinks there is a slam, so she invokes Blackwood. Hearing that SOUTH holds two Aces she bids

6NT. She could also have bid 6



but 6NT scores a little more.

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pass

pass

SOUTH, with 9 points and a 5-card suit, should make a positive response, 2♠.

NORTH bids her



s and SOUTH agrees the trump suit with a

4



bid.